

transmission, including far older ones? How could an archetype concocted in the eighth century supplant all of the older archetypes? I refer to fidelity of transmission. (In our day a concocted text, based on early MSS, has taken over the academic world, but there is no analogy—we know who did it, when, how and why. I have written a page or two on that subject elsewhere.)

Anyone who wishes to advance a theory that Family 35 was concocted by someone in the twelfth century, or the eighth, or the fourth, and do so responsibly, must produce the evidence that gives rise to the theory. He must show who did it, when and where. There are many hundreds of extant copies of NT writings. If all those MSS do not furnish the requisite evidence, then the theory is patently false. To advance a theory that is patently false is to be perverse.

Concerning the Text of the *Pericope Adulterae*

The information offered below is based on Maurice A. Robinson's complete collation of 1,389 MSS that contain the Pericope, John 7:53 - 8:11.¹ I attempted to establish a profile of readings for each of the three main groups of MSS, **M^{5,6,7}** (as in the apparatus of the H-F Majority Text). I take it that the smaller groups are all mixtures based on the big three. This section presents the results, along with my interpretation of their significance.

M⁷ Profile

7:53	01	απηλθεν
8:1	02	Ιησους δε
8:2	03	(βαθεως) = omit
8:2	04	παρεγενετο
8:2	05	προς αυτον
8:3	06	προς αυτον
8:3	07	επι
8:3	08	κατειλημμενην
8:3	09	εν μεσω
8:4	10	λεγουσιν
8:4	11	(πειραζοντες)

¹ 240 MSS omit the PA, 64 of which are based on Theophylact's commentary. Fourteen others have lacunae, but are not witnesses for total omission. A few others certainly contain the passage but the microfilm is illegible. So, 1389 + 240 + 14 + 7(?) = about 1650 MSS checked by Robinson. (These are microfilms held by the *Institut* in Münster. We now know that there are many more extant MSS, and probably even more that are not yet 'extant'.)